

Who gets into production

Standing access is the risk

Nobody decides to hold production credentials forever. They are granted once, for a reason that ends — and the grant does not.

PRESENTER · TEAM

SOURCE — none. No figures in this deck; the argument is mechanical.

WHAT REPLACES IT

**Break-glass, with an expiry
and a written record.**

INTERNAL DISCUSSION DRAFT · 01 / 06

Why permanent access accumulates

#	THE GRANT	WHAT MAKES IT PERMANENT
01	NEVER REVOKED	Granted for an incident, and the incident ended The role outlives the reason. Nothing knows the reason ended.
02	INHERITED	Granted to a group, and the group kept growing Access follows the team, not the task. Joining inherits all of it.
03	THE EXCEPTION	Granted to unblock a launch, and the launch shipped Removing it costs a conversation. Keeping it costs nothing.

Access is the only thing we add without a review date.

What least privilege actually costs

LATENCY

**The fix waits
on a question**

The one who can repair it must ask first, and asking costs most at 03:00.

ATTENTION

**Someone has to
be awake to say yes**

A permission that expires is requested again, and every request needs someone awake.

THE MISSING MAP

**You have to know
what is needed**

Knowing what is needed means knowing it per service and per role, and it goes stale.

Least privilege priced honestly is not free — which is why standing access wins.

What the elevation record has to capture

WHO

A named human, not a role

A record that names a role names nobody.
There is no one left to ask.

WHAT

The account, role and resource

“Production” is a place, not a scope, and
proves only that something happened.

WHY

The ticket, written first

A reason given afterwards is a reason
invented afterwards.

WHEN IT LAPSED

The expiry, and who ended it

A grant with no observed end is standing
access with a form attached.

A record nobody reads is not a record

A NAMED READER

**“Someone reviews it”
means no one does**

A review that belongs to everyone is always about to happen.



A FIXED CADENCE

**On a schedule,
or never at all**

Read weekly, the record is a control. Read after the fact, it is only evidence.



A CONSEQUENCE

**The read must
change something**

If it cannot revoke a role, narrow a scope or close a gap, it is theatre.

A log with no reader or consequence audits as compliant and controls nothing.

DECISIONS

What we need to decide

Standing access is the risk. Break-glass with an expiry, and a record someone actually reads, is what replaces it.

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01 · STANDING ACCESS

Can standing access go to zero, or is there a floor — and who owns what is left?

02 · THE WINDOW

How long does the glass stay broken: a fixed window, or the length of the incident?

03 · THE READER

Who reads the record, how often, and what are they allowed to change?